

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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OUR FOCUS:

FOLLOWING ON TO KNOW GOD
DESIRING TO KNOW GOD MORE

OUR MESSAGE:

TO EXPERIENCE THE CONTINUAL UNVEILING OF GOD TO OUR LIVES.

OUR READING Hosea 6:3

"THEN SHALL WE KNOW THE LORD"

Hosea 6:3 *Then shall we know, if we follow on to know the Lord: his going forth is prepared as the morning; and he shall come unto us as the rain, as the latter and former rain unto the earth. KJV*

Hosea 6:3 *Oh, that we might know the Lord! Let us press on to know him. He will respond to us as surely as the arrival of dawn or the coming of rains in early spring." NLT*

Hosea 6:3 *Yes, let us know (recognize, be acquainted with, and understand) Him; let us be zealous to know the Lord [to appreciate, give heed to, and cherish Him]. His going forth is prepared and certain as the dawn, and He will come to us as the [heavy] rain, as the latter rain that waters the earth. AMP*

KNOWING GOD IS THE MOST IMPORTANT FACTOR IN THE LIFE OF ANY HUMAN BEING AND ESPECIALLY FOR EVERY BELIEVER IN CHRIST JESUS.

But knowledge is never static it increases with experience gained and LATER ON IN LIFE we TEND TO see things differently THAN WHEN WE WERE YOUNGER.

THE QUESTION IS:

AT WHAT LEVEL OR MEASURE OF UNDERSTANDING CAN WE KNOW GOD?

Here are three different levels that we can know God

1. Knowing him OBJECTIVELY
2. Knowing him SUBJECTIVELY
3. Knowing him EXPERIENTIALLY

What is the difference between objectively, subjectively, and experientially?

OBJECTIVELY

Focuses on verifiable facts and evidence that can be verified and not influenced by personal feelings or opinions. It aims for impartiality and unbiased assessments.

SUBJECTIVELY

Means based on personal feelings, opinions, or tastes. Something that is subjective is based on personal opinions and feelings rather than on facts.

It's about how an individual perceives something, which can vary greatly from person to person.

EXPERIENTIALLY

Means relating to or based on experience. It signifies that something is gained or understood through direct involvement or observation, rather than through instruction or theory.

Example

We came to know God as Saviour and Lord through the salvation experience, discovering a loving heavenly father and experienced through his miraculous power and deliverance etc.

BUT even though such experiences were thrilling and enthralled our whole being there is still the IMPORTANT FACTOR facing every believer OF PROGRESSIVELY KNOWING GOD IN A DEEPER AND MORE MEANINGFUL WAY OF PERSONALLY EXPERIENCING THE ON-GOING PROGRESSION OF THE KNOWLEDGE OF GOD BY THE UNVEILING OF THE SPIRIT TO OUR HEARTS.

▼ Hosea 6:3 *Then shall we know, if we follow on to know the Lord: his going forth is prepared as the morning; and he shall come unto us as the rain, as the latter and former rain unto the earth. KJV*

THE QUESTION RAISED IN THIS PASSAGE IS THAT THERE IS ADDITIONAL KNOWLEDGE OF GOD AVAILABLE TO US IF WE EARNESTLY DESIRE IT.

He will come to us and unveil himself to us BUT it IS CONDITIONAL THEN – and IF THEN SHALL WE KNOW – IF WE FOLLOW ON

If we continue in our pursuit of knowing God more intimately, we will know more.

HE WILL COME TO US

He will respond to us as surely as he arranges the arrival of the dawn every day.

God in person shall come to us – and unveil himself to us in some new way.

“Then shall we know” is referring to the progression of knowing God in addition to the knowledge that we may have already have.

JESUS UNVEILED HIMSELF TO HIS FOLLOWERS.

Like 24: 27 And beginning at Moses and all the prophets, he expounded unto them in all the scriptures the things concerning himself.

Like 24: 32 And they said one to another, Did not our heart burn within us, while he talked with us by the way, and while he opened to us the scriptures?

Mark 4:34 But without a parable spake he not unto them: and when they were alone, he expounded all things to his disciples.

JESUS HIDDEN IN SCRIPTURE.

Wow, what an exciting adventure and challenge set before us to discover the hidden Jesus in scripture in a way that we have not previously seen him.

In the searching of the scriptures, he is unveiled to us, and we see more of what has already been written of him.

Such unveilings of Christ that produces a powerful motivation towards discipleship.

THE KEY TO THIS CONTINUAL UNVEILING OF GOD IS IF WE “FOLLOW ON”

- ▼ Are we willing to ‘follow on’ so we might know more?
- ▼ Do we desire God to unveil himself more from the Scriptures. NOTE that it is from the scriptures, (that which has already been written) – AND not THROUGH personal dreams, visions etc.
- ▼ ARE WE HUNGRY FOR THE UNVEILING OF CHRIST AND GOD REVEALED IN THE SCRIPTURES?

IN OUR ‘FOLLOWING ON’ (i.e. continued discipleship)

ARE WE HUNGRY TO KNOW HIM IN THIS DIMENSION?

JESUS IS REALLY ASKING; WILL YOU WALK WITH ME IN THE PATHWAY I WALKED?

Mark 8:34 And having called the rows together with his disciples TO HIMSELF, He said to them, If anyone is desiring to come after me as a follower of mine, let him AT ONCE BEGIN to lose sight of himself and his own interests, and let him AT ONCE BEGIN to take up his cross and carry it, and LET HIM START taking the SAME road that I travel IN COMPANY WITH ME, and LET HIM CONTINUE to do so moment by moment. Kenneth Wuest

FOLLOWING ON MEANS:

- Continuing daily in close fellowship and communion with God and responding speedily to his vice and command to go, come and walk etc.
- Remaining in faith and continued trust in God even when the future pathway is not clear to us.
- Continuing to be a burden bearer and showing a servant’s heart even though there are few others who will walk with you.
- Remaining true to God without compromising his standards of godliness and sound doctrine.
- Continuing to maintain personal integrity, honesty, the keeping our word when given, and being accountable for our actions.
- Accepting God’s correction and knowing that it is not rejection.

Hosea 6:3 Let us acknowledge Yahweh. Let us press on to know Yahweh. As surely as the sun rises, Yahweh will appear. He will come to us like the rain, Like the spring rain that waters the earth." WEB
Amen - Pastor Barry.